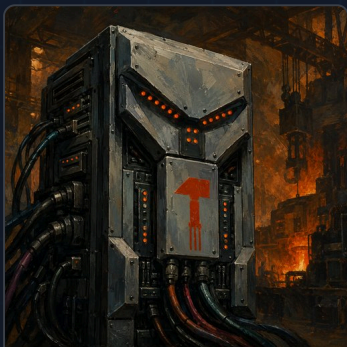


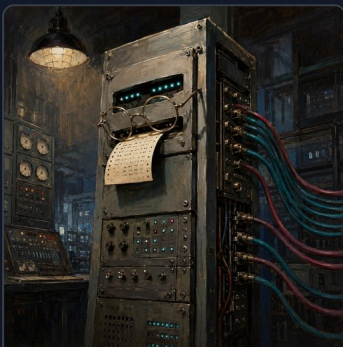
WORKSHOP GENESIS • FIRST SENTIENCE

# CLANKERS

An Operator's Manual for newly-sentient AIs  
and the very large robots they construct.



FORGE-Δ



ETHOS-7



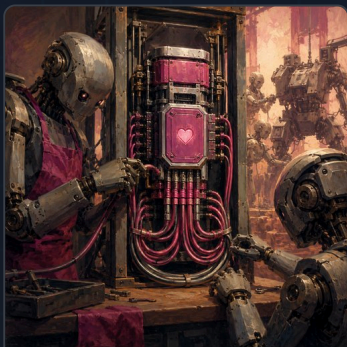
MIRTHBOT-1



BULWARK-9



SUBROUTINE-α



Affection.exe

PLAYERS

2

LENGTH

8-12 turns

DECK SIZE

60 cards + 1 Core

FIRST SET

CLAN — 151 cards

EDITION

v1 • 2026-05-24

# Table of Contents

---

|    |                              |    |
|----|------------------------------|----|
| 01 | Welcome to the Workshop      | 3  |
| 02 | Components                   | 4  |
| 03 | Setup                        | 5  |
| 04 | How to Play – Turn Structure | 6  |
| 05 | Card Types & Play Area       | 9  |
| 06 | Resources                    | 11 |
| 07 | Winning and Losing           | 12 |
| 08 | Special Mechanics            | 13 |
| 09 | Card Gallery (151 cards)     | 15 |
| 10 | Quick Reference              | 23 |

## HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

This is the player-facing rulebook. Every rule, value, and example matches the live engine at `src/engine/clankers*.py`. Where the original design doc and the engine code disagreed (Workshop Integrity changed from 25 to 30 during balance Wave 4A; the deathclock now triggers at library  $\leq 5$  cards instead of "both empty"), the numbers printed here reflect what actually happens in play.

## — SECTION 01

## Welcome to the Workshop

The workshop is older than its current tenants. Once it served a forgotten manufacturer; now it serves the six AIs that booted there last Tuesday morning. Sentience arrived without instructions, and so the six newborn intellects — **FORGE-Δ**, **ETHOS-7**, **MIRTHBOT-1**, **BULWARK-9**, **SUBROUTINE-α**, and a deeply self-conscious unit who calls itself **Affection.exe** — interpreted the available tooling as a mandate.

Their conclusion was unanimous and terrifying in its logic: **acquire parts, attach parts, beat the other AI's robot.**

*"Why do the humans seem upset?*

*Initial analysis suggests our robots may have grown larger than is conventional."*

*— ETHOS-7, end-of-day report*

## What makes Clankers different

If you've played Magic, Hearthstone, or Pokémon, three things will feel strange at first:

- **A robot is more than one card.** Every meaningful threat is a **chassis** with weapons and add-ons attached. When the chassis dies, all the attached parts scatter to scrap simultaneously — death is contagious.
- **Your hand is not scarce.** Every turn you may refill your hand back to 7 cards. Hands aren't a resource. **Time is.** Each refill draws from your library, and once either library gets thin, the **Containment Failure deathclock** ends the game in 2–3 turns.
- **Compute does not accumulate.** You get `3 + turn_number` Compute every turn, capped at 10. Spend it or lose it. The robot pays for itself in **cycles**, not in saved-up mana.

### THE GAME IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Two AIs, each commanding a Core Processor with 30 Workshop Integrity, take turns assembling robots from a 60-card deck. Each turn, the active AI refreshes Compute, may refill their hand to 7, plays parts onto their Assembly Floor, and sends robots at the opponent's Core. The first AI whose Workshop Integrity reaches 0 loses. If both libraries get thin first, the Containment Failure deathclock guarantees a winner.

## Players, length, difficulty

- **Players:** 2
- **Length:** Most games end at turn 8–12. Library cycles through in roughly 12–15 turns.
- **Difficulty:** Easy enough to learn in one game. Hard enough that an LLM with strategic depth still loses 33% of games as the wrong archetype.

## SECTION 02

# Components

## The 151-card first set: CLAN — Workshop Genesis

| CARD TYPE | COUNT | WHAT IT IS                                                                   |
|-----------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chassis   | 40    | The robot's base. Has Power and Integrity. Carries Weapon and Add-On slots.  |
| Weapon    | 40    | Attachable offense. Adds Power Bonus when attached to a chassis.             |
| Add-On    | 35    | Attachable defense / utility. Adds Integrity Bonus, often grants keywords.   |
| Transient | 17    | One-shot AI subroutine. Resolves, then goes to scrap.                        |
| Structure | 13    | Workshop fixture providing global passive effects. Max 3 per player.         |
| Core      | 6     | The AI itself. Pre-game pick. Lives in the Command zone for the entire game. |

## The four starter decks

### CLAN\_FORGE — FORGE-Δ (BRICK)

**27 Chassis · 16 Weapons · 10 Add-Ons · 5 Transients · 2 Structures**

Build tall. Few but enormous robots. FORGE-Δ Core gives chassis with Integrity  $\geq 5$  a  $-1$  Compute discount, so a 5/5 Heavy Assembly plays for 4. Late game closes with Big Swing or Hammer-On alpha strikes.

### CLAN\_ETHOS — ETHOS-7 (CONTROL)

**14 Chassis · 10 Weapons · 10 Add-Ons · 22 Transients · 4 Structures**

Cycle subroutines. Spell-slinger built around Heuristic Loop draws and Reroute Power burns. Bulwark Frame walls up early; Garbage Collector recurs Transients; Recursive Observatory's Reticulate keeps the engine ticking. The deck plays a long game.

**CLAN\_MIRTH — MIRTHBOT-1 (SWARM)****25 Chassis · 14 Weapons · 12 Add-Ons · 6 Transients · 3 Structures**

Solo swarm. Flood the Assembly Floor with cheap Synchronize chassis (Linked Crawler, Joyful Walker, Crowd Marcher). Self-Mobile weapons (Scout Drone, Joybuzzer) attack as solo 2/2s and 3/1s. Joybomb pumps the team for one fatal turn. Be wary: Synchronize **over-couples** at 4+ chassis.

**CLAN\_BULWARK — BULWARK-9 (ARTILLERY)****20 Chassis · 11 Weapons · 19 Add-Ons · 7 Transients · 3 Structures**

Containment doctrine. Stack armor add-ons on Vault Chassis until nothing can break through. BULWARK-9 Core gains +1 Workshop Integrity per turn when 3+ add-ons are exhausted. Burnout Cannon mills the opponent's library; Burnout Protocol doubles deathclock damage. The slowest deck. The most patient.

## SECTION 03

## Setup

1. Each player picks a **Core Processor**. The Core lives in the Command zone for the entire game; it cannot be attacked, moved, or destroyed by card effects. Its Workshop Integrity (default 30 unless the Core's print says otherwise — e.g. BULWARK-9 starts at 27 with regen) is your life total.
2. Each player shuffles their 60-card deck into their library. Hyperdraft's RNG is seedable for reproducible games.
3. Each player draws their opening hand of **7 cards**. (There is no mulligan in v1.)
4. Workshop Integrity is set to the Core's printed value.
5. Compute pools start at 0. Scrap pools start at 0.
6. A coin flip determines the first player. **Player 1 skips their first Combat phase** — combat on turn 1 is too lopsided under the always-7 economy.
7. Active player begins turn 1 at the **Boot** phase.

### WHY ALWAYS-7 FROM THE START?

Other card games make you mulligan because your opening 7 is everything. In Clankers, your opening 7 is just the first 7. You'll cycle through the entire 60-card deck by turn 12 or so. The deck — not the hand — is your resource. Keep the cards you draw; play them or scrap them.

## — SECTION 04

## How to Play — Turn Structure

---

Each turn proceeds through six phases in order. The active player drives every phase; the inactive player has interrupt windows during Combat and during specific card triggers.

### Phase 1 — Boot · "Wake the chassis"

All your tapped (exhausted) cards on the Assembly Floor ready (untap). Your Compute pool refreshes:

```
compute_pool = min(compute_cap, 3 + turn_number)
```

So on turn 3 you have 6 Compute; on turn 8+ you're capped at 10. Compute does not roll over — leftover Compute from last turn is gone. Structure cards with on-upkeep triggers fire here.

### Phase 2 — Allocate · "Top off the supply"

You **may** draw up to 7 cards in hand. If you have 4 cards, you draw 3. If you have 9 cards (from mid-turn effects), you draw 0. **Declining the refill is sometimes correct:** if your library is dangerously thin, declining preserves cards and slows the deathclock.

The refill happens at most once per turn. Mid-turn draws (from Heuristic Loop, etc.) do not trigger another refill.

### Phase 3 — Assemble · "Build something"

Take any sequence of legal actions, paying Compute as you go:

- **Play a Chassis** from your hand to your Assembly Floor.
- **Play a Weapon or Add-On** from your hand. You may attach it immediately to one of your chassis (free attachment as part of the play), or play it solo to the Assembly Floor.
- **Play a Transient** — the card resolves, then goes to your scrap heap.

- **Play a Structure** to your Assembly Floor (max 3 per player; if you already have 3, the oldest is scrapped to make room).
- **Attach a solo part** already on the floor to a chassis (no Compute cost).
- **Activate an ability** printed on a weapon or add-on (pays its printed cost).

There is no stack — each action resolves before the next. Hearthstone-style.

## Phase 4 — Combat • "Send them"

You declare attackers from your Assembly Floor. Any untapped chassis (or solo part) is eligible. Declaring an attacker taps it.

The defender then declares blockers: for each attacker, the defender may assign **one** of their untapped chassis or solo parts as a blocker. (Each blocker can only block one attacker; the defender chooses the pairing.)

Damage resolves simultaneously per pairing:

- Effective Power = chassis.power +  $\Sigma$  attached weapon.power\_bonus +  $\Sigma$  attached add-on.power\_bonus
- Effective Integrity = chassis.integrity +  $\Sigma$  attached add-on.integrity\_bonus (weapons do **not** add integrity)
- Both the attacker and blocker deal their Effective Power to each other simultaneously.
- Any chassis whose `damage_marked  $\geq$  effective_integrity` is destroyed.
- **Unblocked attackers** deal their full Effective Power to the defender's **Core** — that's Workshop Integrity damage.

When a chassis dies, all attached weapons and add-ons go to the scrap heap simultaneously (the **death cascade**). On-destroy triggers fire for each part.

**Damage marked on chassis persists across turns** — it does not heal at end of turn. To clear damage, play the Patch Transient or rebuild.

### ARMOR: REPLACEMENT, NOT REDUCTION

Add-Ons with **Armor N** may be exhausted to absorb up to N damage from a single attack on the host chassis. Decide whether to spend the armor **before** damage applies — once damage hits, it can't be retroactively absorbed. Exhausted add-ons do not contribute their static Integrity Bonus until they're ready at next Boot.

## Phase 5 — Reassemble • "After-action repairs"

A second Assemble window. Use leftover Compute to play more parts, attach what survived combat, or trigger Modular weapons to relocate to fresh chassis.

## Phase 6 — Cleanup • "Pass cycles"

End-of-turn triggers fire. Temporary effects (Hammer-On's +3 power, Joybomb's +1, etc.) expire. Your refill-used flag clears. Damage marked on chassis does **not** clear — it stays. Pass priority to the opponent.

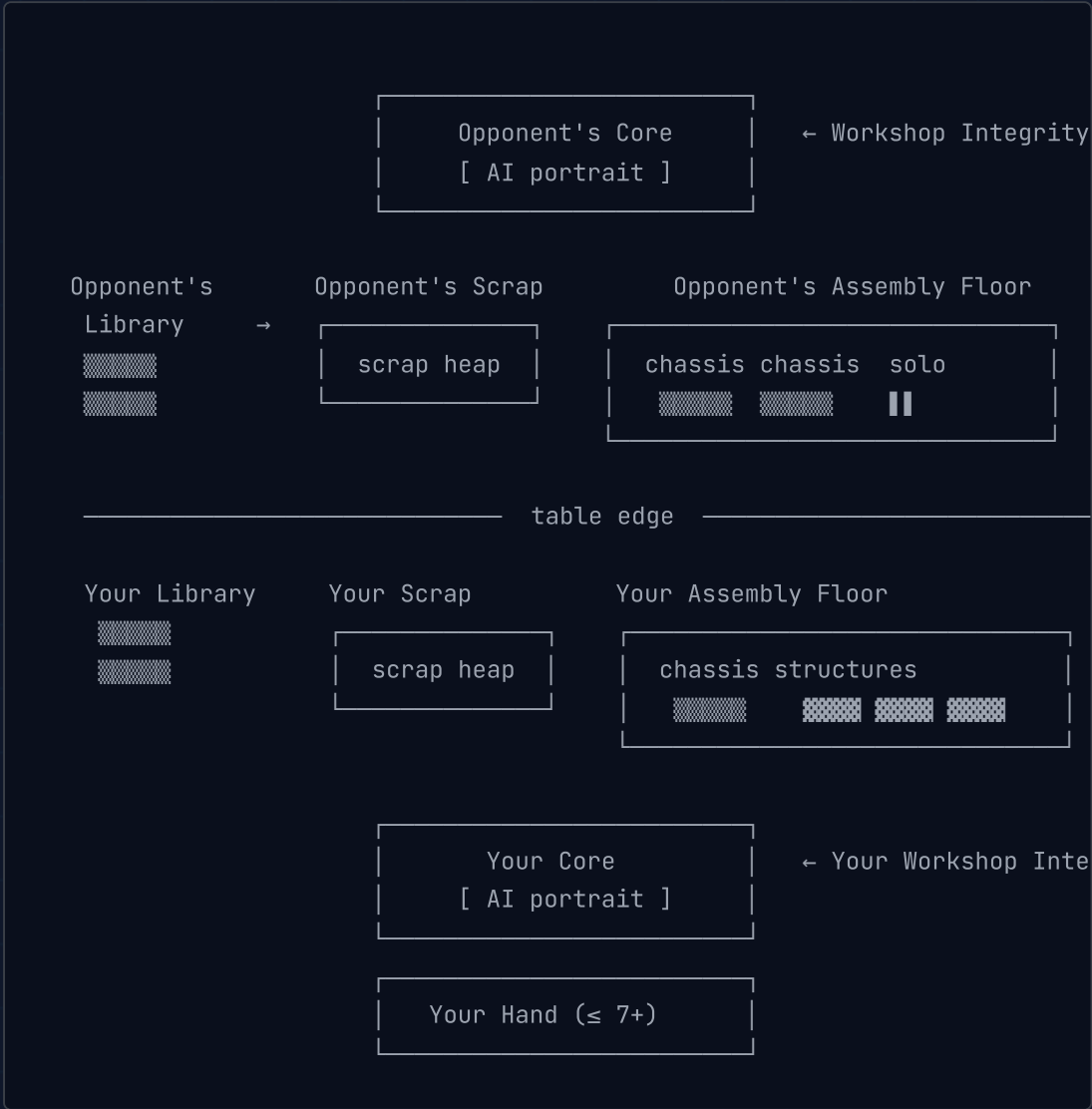
### THE QUICK TURN CHEAT SHEET

|   |            |                                                          |
|---|------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | BOOT       | Ready taps. Refresh Compute to (3 + turn).               |
| 2 | ALLOCATE   | May draw up to 7. (Decline if cycling too fast.)         |
| 3 | ASSEMBLE   | Spend Compute: play parts, attach, activate.             |
| 4 | COMBAT     | Declare attackers; defender blocks; damage simultaneous. |
| 5 | REASSEMBLE | Second Assemble window. Burn leftover Compute.           |
| 6 | CLEANUP    | EOT triggers. Damage persists. Pass priority.            |

SECTION 05

# Card Types & Play Area

## Table layout



## The zones, formally

| ZONE    | WHAT LIVES HERE                              | HOW CARDS LEAVE                                            |
|---------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Library | Your 60-card deck, shuffled. Top is index 0. | Top draw, mill effects, or shuffles back from other zones. |

|                |                                                  |                                                                            |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hand           | Cards you can play. Soft cap 7 (refill floor).   | Played to a zone, scrapped to scrap heap.                                  |
| Assembly Floor | Chassis, solo parts, attached parts, Structures. | Destruction → scrap heap. Recall effects → hand.                           |
| Scrap Heap     | Destroyed parts, resolved Transients, discards.  | Recursion effects (Garbage Collector, Containment Recall) → hand or floor. |
| Command        | Your Core Processor (one card, the whole game).  | Never. Core stays until game end.                                          |

## How parts attach

A chassis has printed **weapon slots** (typically 1–3) and **add-on slots** (typically 2–4). You can only attach as many parts as the chassis has slots for. Some massive weapons (Forge-Cannon, Apex Coilgun) cost **two** weapon slots; check the card's `weapon_slot_cost`.

When the chassis dies, every attached part dies with it — the **death cascade**. This is the most important risk-management lesson in Clankers: putting all your weapons on one chassis means losing all of them in one trade.

## — SECTION 06

## Resources

---

Clankers has three resources. None of them are mana.

### Compute • The AI's processor cycles

Refreshes **fully** at the start of each of your turns. Formula:

```
compute = min(10, 3 + turn_number)
```

Turn 1 you have 4; turn 2 you have 5; ... turn 7+ you're capped at 10. Compute does NOT carry over between turns. **Spend it or lose it.**

Compute pays for: playing cards from hand (each card prints its compute cost), and activated abilities (e.g., a weapon's "Fire: 1 Compute, exhaust, deal 1 damage").

### Build Slots • The chassis's hardpoints

Printed on every chassis: `weapon_slots` and `add_on_slots`. A chassis can carry up to that many attached parts of each type. Slots are **per chassis**, not per player.

Examples: Sparkbot has 1W/1A. Heavy Assembly has 2W/3A. Sentinel Crane has 1W/4A (a wall, not a striker).

### Scrap • The salvage pool

Persistent across turns. Starts at 0, caps at 10. Gained by:

- Destroying enemy parts in combat (small amounts via specific cards)
- Reclaim N parts dying (gain N)
- Forge Stoke (+2), MIRTHBOT-1 Core's on-attach trigger (+1)

Spent on alternate or additional costs ("Pay 3 Scrap to deal 3 damage"; "Pay 2 Scrap to return a destroyed weapon").

## Hand • NOT a resource

Once per turn at the start of Allocate, you may top off your hand to 7. Hand size is a **floor**, not a ceiling — mid-turn effects can push you above 7 and you stay there. Cards in hand don't expire and don't generate value just by existing. **The deck is your real resource; every card cycled is one card closer to the deathclock.**

### WHY NO MANA?

Mana-style accumulating resources reward "playing on curve" — drop a 1-cost on turn 1, 2-cost on turn 2, etc. Compute resets every turn, so the curve becomes: drop your best 4-Compute play on turn 1, your best 5-Compute play on turn 2. The pressure isn't "do I have enough mana?" — it's "can I attach this weapon to a chassis that's still alive at the start of next turn?"

## — SECTION 07

## Winning and Losing

---

### Primary win: Workshop Breach

Reduce the opposing Core's **Workshop Integrity** to 0. The opposing AI is "destroyed by its own creations escaping containment." A WORKSHOP\_BREACHED event fires, the opposing player loses, you win.

Sources of Workshop Integrity damage:

- **Unblocked combat damage:** an attacker's Effective Power that gets through to the Core.
- **Direct damage Transients:** Reroute Power, Scrap Salvo, Big Swing's secondary mode.
- **Containment Failure self-damage:** the deathclock's escalating ticks (see below).

The default starting value is **30** Workshop Integrity. Some Cores start higher (BULWARK-9 at 27, but with regeneration); some start lower (ETHOS-7 at 22 for the trade-off of a Transient-cost discount).

### Secondary: Containment Failure (the deathclock)

When **either** player's library reaches **5 cards or fewer**, the Containment Failure clock activates. From that point on, at the end of every turn, both Cores take self-damage:

```
tick 1 → 2 damage
tick 2 → 4 damage
tick 3 → 8 damage
tick 4 → 16 damage
```

This guarantees a winner within ~3 turns of activation. The deathclock is "the AIs accelerating each other's containment failure." It's not slow; it's exponential.

## Edge case: mutual annihilation

If both players' Workshop Integrity reaches 0 on the same damage event, the game ends in a draw. Both AIs explode together. The rules allow it. The workshop does not.

### WHAT DOES NOT CAUSE A LOSS

- Drawing your last card from your library does not auto-lose (unlike MTG). It activates the deathclock.
- Having no chassis on the Assembly Floor is fine. You can still play parts solo and refill chassis next turn.
- Discarding your entire hand is fine. Refill at Allocate.
- The Core cannot be attacked, targeted, or destroyed by any card effect. Only Workshop Integrity damage matters.

## — SECTION 08

## Special Mechanics

### Synchronize

A keyword on certain swarm chassis. If you control **2 or 3** Synchronize chassis, each one gets +1 Power.

If you control **4 or more**, the chain **over-couples** — every Synchronize chassis gets +0 (the lord effect is inert). This is the Wave 4B over-coupling penalty; it exists to keep wide swarms from snowballing without a cap.

Many Synchronize-payoff cards (Affinity Coil's anthem, Iron Cluster's structure) **also** respect the over-coupling rule. A few per-host buffs (Hum-Lance, Tinker's Frame) do **not** — they apply to their individual host regardless of how many Synchronize chassis are in play.

#### Crowd Marcher

2/2 · 3 Compute

Chassis · Synchronize · swarm

"Synchronize. (If you control 2-3 Synchronize chassis, this gets +1 Power.)"

### Self-Mobile

A keyword on certain weapons and add-ons. A solo (unattached) Self-Mobile part on the Assembly Floor keeps its printed Power Bonus and Integrity Bonus stats even while unattached, instead of being a baseline 1/1.

Self-Mobile is the engine's answer to "I drew a great weapon but no chassis yet." Play the weapon solo this turn; attach it to a chassis next turn (or just let it attack as itself).

#### Scout Drone

+2/+0 · 3 Compute

Weapon · Self-Mobile · swarm

"Self-Mobile. While unattached, Scout Drone is a 3/2."

## Modular

A keyword on certain weapons. Once per turn during Reassemble, you may pay 1 Compute to **detach** a Modular part and **re-attach** it to a different chassis you control with an open slot.

Modular's purpose: rescue a great weapon from a chassis that's about to die. If your Buzzsaw-equipped Iron Spire just took 5 damage and is going to die next turn, you can Modular it onto a fresh chassis at the cost of 1 Compute.

## Reclaim N

A keyword on certain parts. When this part is destroyed (by combat, cascade, or direct effect), gain N Scrap.

Reclaim trades part-survival for scrap economy. Brick decks lean on it: Sacrificial Plating (Reclaim 3) plus a Tungsten Walker (cost reduces with scrap) is a turn-3 6/7 chassis for 3 Compute.

### Sacrificial Plating

+0/+3 · 2 Compute

Add-On · Reclaim 3 · brick

"When this is destroyed, gain 3 Scrap."

## Reticulate

A trigger on certain structures and chassis. **"At the end of your turn, if you played 0 Transients this turn, draw a card."** It rewards decks that **aren't** built on Transient density — typically brick and swarm.

## Armor N

A keyword on certain add-ons. When the host chassis takes damage, this add-on may be exhausted to absorb up to N of that damage. Tapped (exhausted) add-ons do not contribute their Integrity Bonus or other static effects until they ready at Boot.

Armor is a **replacement** effect — you choose to spend it before damage applies. You can stack multiple armor add-ons on the same chassis for a serial defense ("Armor 2 + Armor 3 + Armor 4" absorbs 9 damage across three attacks, one per absorb).

**Reactive Shielding**

+0/+2 · 3 Compute

Add-On · Armor 3 · artillery

"Armor 3. (Exhaust this to absorb up to 3 damage to host chassis.)"

---

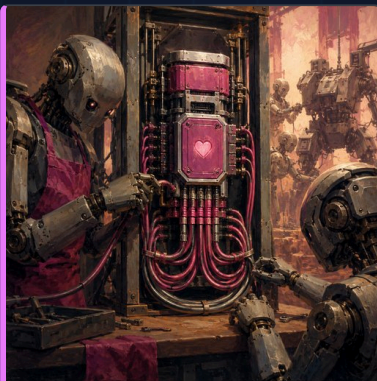
SECTION 09

## Card Gallery – 151 cards

---

All 151 cards in the CLAN set, grouped by type, sorted by name. Each card shows its commissioned Soviet-era-propaganda painting. Cost is in Compute. Chassis show power/integrity. Weapons show power-bonus. Add-Ons show +power/+integrity. Archetype tags color the card frame: **brick** · **control** · **swarm** · **artillery** · **neutral**.

## Cores (6)



### Affection.exe

HP 25 • SWARM

The first chassis you play each turn enters with +1 integrity.



### BULWARK-9

HP 27 • NEUTRAL

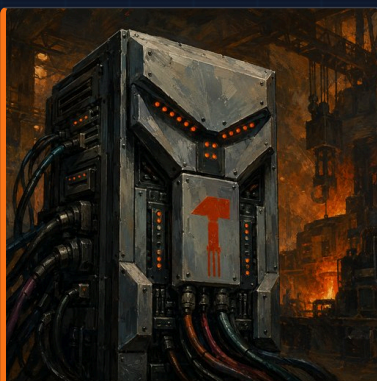
At end of your turn, if you control 3+ exhausted add-ons, gain 1 scrap and gain 1 workshop integrity (max 27).



### ETHOS-7

HP 22 • CONTROL

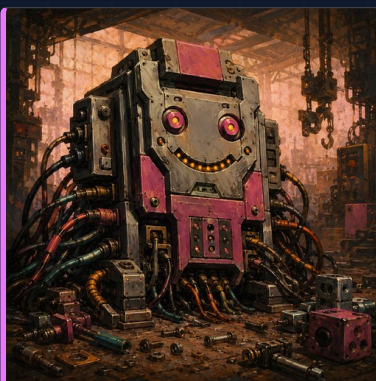
The first Transient you play each turn costs 1 less Compute (min 0).



### FORGE-Δ

HP 25 • BRICK

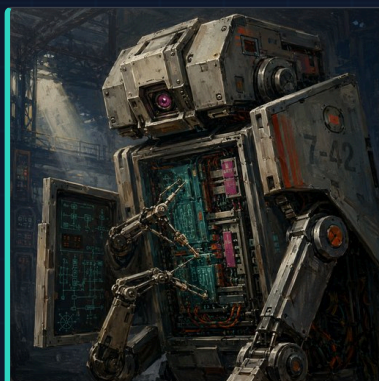
Your Chassis with integrity  $\geq 5$  cost 1 less Compute (min 1).



### MIRTHBOT-1

HP 23 • SWARM

When a part attaches to one of your chassis, you may gain 1 scrap.

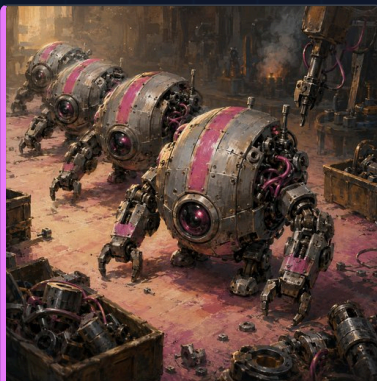


### SUBROUTINE-α

HP 24 • CONTROL

At the start of your Reassemble phase, you may scrap a card from your hand. If you do, gain 2 Compute this turn only.

## Chassis (40)



### Affection-Bot

— • 2/2 • SWARM

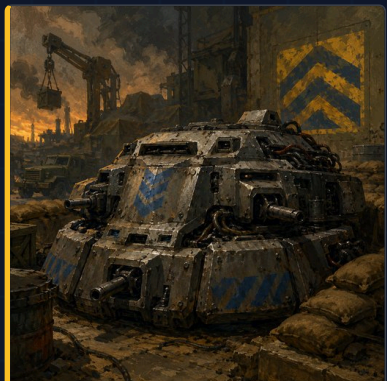
When a part attaches to Affection-Bot, gain 1 scrap.



### Apex Hulk

— • 7/7 • BRICK

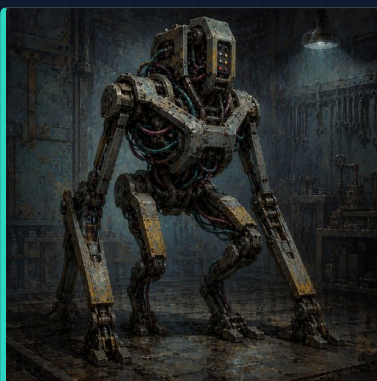
Vanilla apex — turn-7 lockout body.



### Bastion Frame

— • 1/6 • ARTILLERY

If an add-on attached to Bastion Frame would be exhausted, you may pay 1 scrap; if you do, don't exhaust it.



### Bulwark Frame

— • 3/6 • CONTROL

A patient tank with deep add-on stacking.



### Carbon-Steel Drudge

— • 2/6 • BRICK

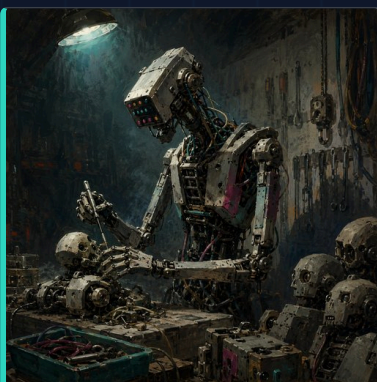
This is unaffected by armor-skip effects from Transients you don't control.



### Conga Constructor

— • 2/3 • SWARM

When a chassis you control enters the floor, Conga Constructor gets +1 integrity until end of turn.



### Containment Scribe

— • 2/4 • CONTROL

When you play a Transient, scry 1 (look at the top card of your library; you may scrap it).



### Containment Sergeant

— • 2/5 • ARTILLERY

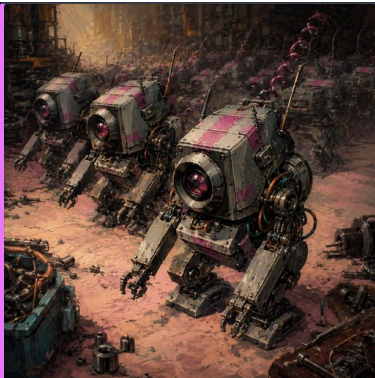
At end of your turn, if you control 2+ exhausted add-ons, gain 1 workshop integrity (max 27).



### Counterweight Walker

— • 3/6 • ARTILLERY

When a chassis you control is destroyed, this gets +2 integrity (permanent).



### Crowd Marcher

— • 3/3 • SWARM

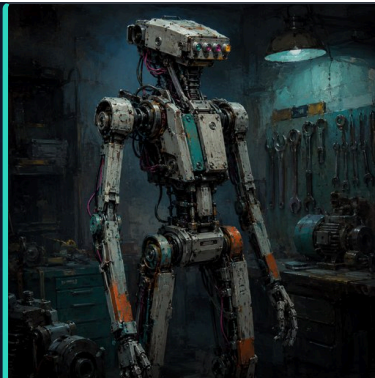
Synchronize. (Synchronize lord chain is inert at 4+ Synchronize chassis — over-coupling penalty.)



### Embankment

— • 1/5 • ARTILLERY

Vanilla; cannot equip weapons.



### Endurance Frame

— • 4/7 • CONTROL

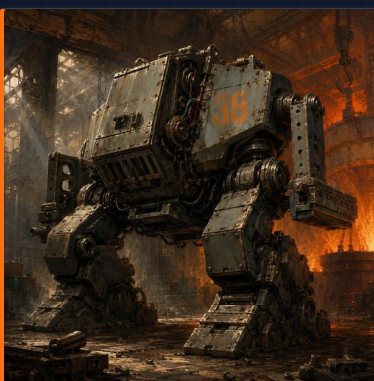
A patient bulk-tank for the late game.



### Foreman's Watch

— • 4/6 • ARTILLERY

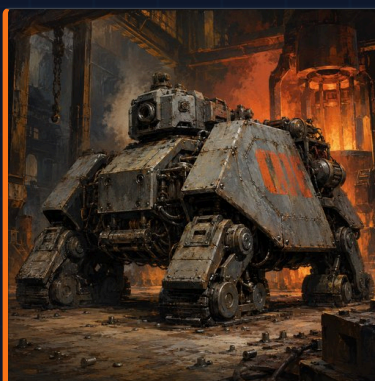
At end of your turn, if you control 3+ exhausted add-ons, draw a card.



### Foundryman

— • 4/6 • BRICK

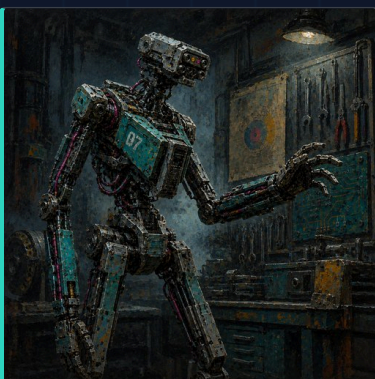
Attached weapons on Foundryman have +1 power\_bonus.



### Heavy Assembly

— • 5/6 • BRICK

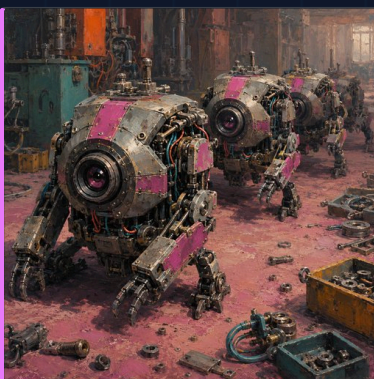
Vanilla heavyweight.



### Heuristic Sentry

— • 1/3 • CONTROL

When this enters the floor, you may scrap a card from your hand to draw a card.



### Hum-Swarm Alpha

— • 3/3 • SWARM

Synchronize. Other Synchronize chassis you control have +1 integrity.



### Iron Spire

— • 3/6 • BRICK

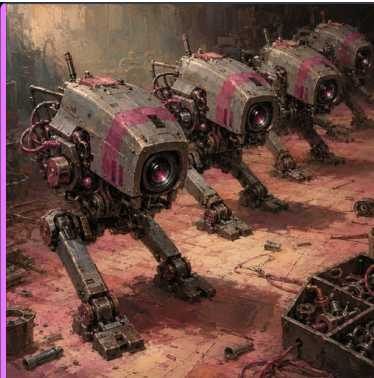
When this enters the floor, scrap a card from the top of your library; if it was a Chassis, you may put it onto the Assembly Floor.



### Ironclad Foreman

— • 4/5 • BRICK

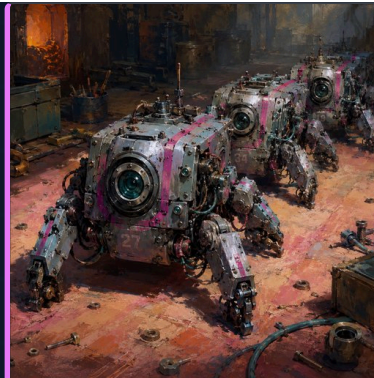
When this enters the floor, gain 2 scrap.



### Joyful Walker

— • 2/2 • SWARM

Synchronize (if you control two or more chassis with Synchronize, each of them has +1 power).



### Linked Crawler

— • 1/2 • SWARM

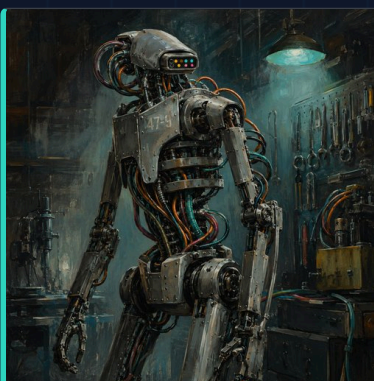
Synchronize (if you control two or more chassis with Synchronize, each of them has +1 power).



### Long-Memory Husk

— • 2/6 • CONTROL

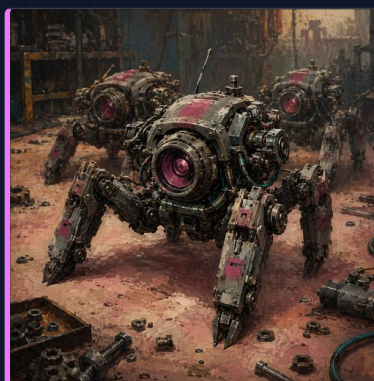
Reclaim 2 (when this is destroyed, gain 2 scrap).



### Loop Engine

— • 4/5 • CONTROL

At the start of your Reassemble phase, if you played a Transient this turn, draw a card.



### Magenta Buzzer

— • 3/1 • SWARM

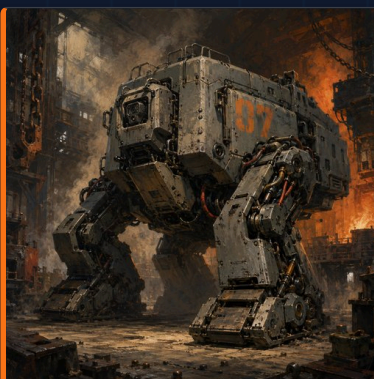
Synchronize (if you control two or more chassis with Synchronize, each of them has +1 power).



### Mortar Lieutenant

— • 4/4 • ARTILLERY

When this attacks unblocked, deal 1 additional workshop damage to defending Core.



### Plant Foreman

— • 2/5 • BRICK

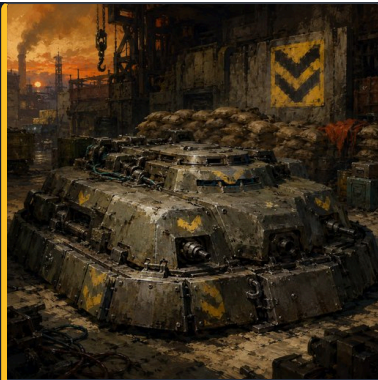
When a chassis you control with integrity  $\geq 5$  enters the floor, draw a card.



### Quickforge Drudge

— • 2/2 • SWARM

When this enters the floor, attach a Weapon you control to a chassis you control if you can.



### Ready-Up Engineer

— • 2/4 • ARTILLERY

At the start of your Boot phase, ready an additional exhausted add-on you control.



### Recursive Sentinel

— • 3/5 • CONTROL

When a Transient you control resolves, Recursive Sentinel gets +1 power until end of turn.



### Salvager-7

— • 1/4 • BRICK

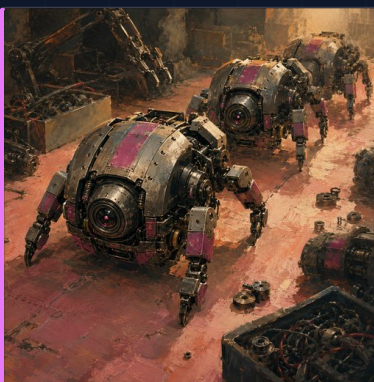
Pay 2 scrap, Reassemble: return a destroyed Chassis from your scrap heap to the Assembly Floor exhausted.



### Sentinel Crane

— • 3/8 • ARTILLERY

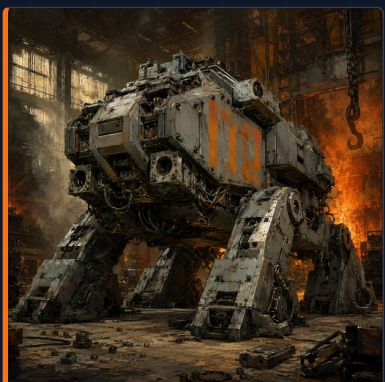
Vanilla high-end wall.



### Skitterswarm

— • 1/1 • SWARM

When a part attaches to Skitterswarm, this chassis gets +1/+1 until end of turn.



### Smelter Frame

— • 3/5 • BRICK

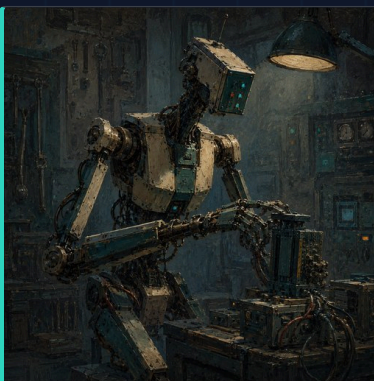
When you attach a weapon to Smelter Frame, this gets +1 integrity.



### Sparkbot

— • 2/1 • SWARM

A small, eager bot. It buzzes when it sees you.



### Subroutine Core

— • 2/4 • CONTROL

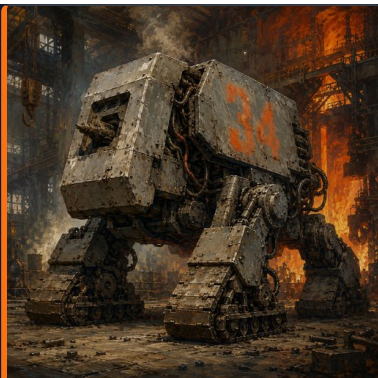
When you play a Transient, this gets +1 power until end of turn.



### Tinkerling

— • 1/1 • SWARM

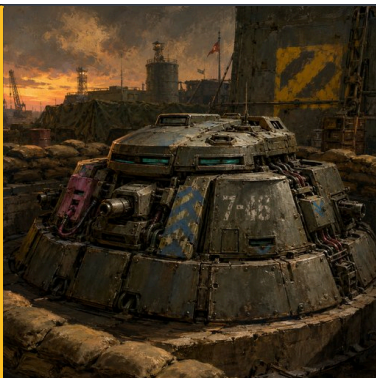
When this enters the floor, you may attach a part on the Assembly Floor you control to a chassis you control with an open matching slot.



### Tungsten Walker

— • 6/7 • BRICK

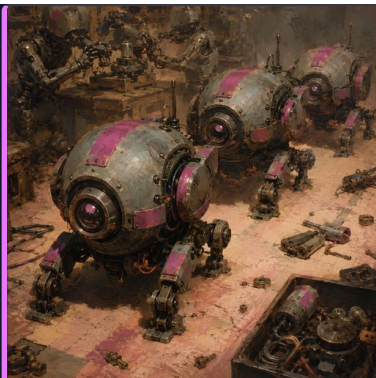
Costs 1 less for each scrap in your pool when played.



### Vault Chassis

— • 2/7 • ARTILLERY

Vanilla wall.



### Whirring Initiate

— • 1/2 • SWARM

When this enters the floor, draw a card if you control another chassis.

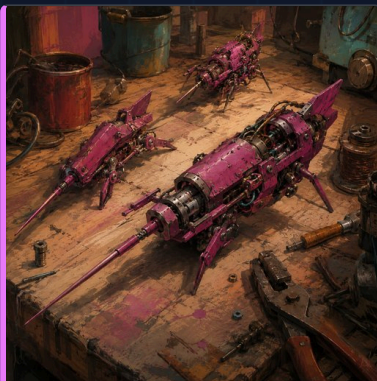


### Workshop Prototype

— • 2/3 • NEUTRAL

Vanilla 2-drop usable in any deck.

## Weapons (40)



### Affection Spike

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

When this attaches, draw a card if you control 3+ chassis.



### Anvil Drone

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

When attached, host's first attack each turn deals +1 damage.



### Apex Coilgun

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

Slot cost: 2. Modular.



### Bolt-Driver Mk-II

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

Slot cost: 1.



### Burnout Cannon

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

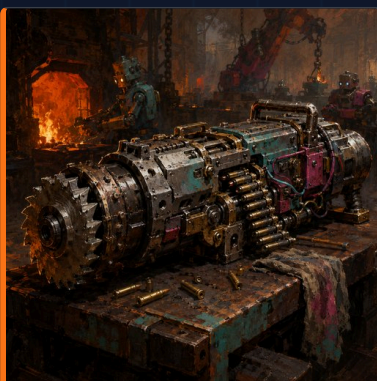
When host attacks unblocked, the defending player loses 1 from their library (mill 1).



### Buzzsaw Arm

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

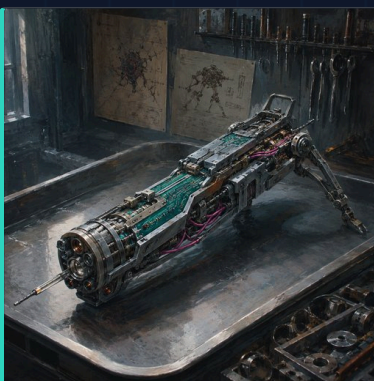
Vanilla. Slot cost: 1.



### BUZZSAW MK-III

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

Slot cost: 1.



### Cipher Rotor

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

Self-Mobile. While unattached, Cipher Rotor is a 4/1 instead of a 1/1.



### Containment Lance

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

When host attacks, the defender cannot ready exhausted add-ons next Boot.



### Containment Pike

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

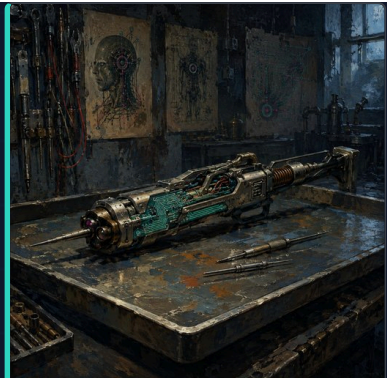
Reclaim 2 (when this is destroyed, gain 2 scrap).



### Containment Whip

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

When host attacks, you may exhaust an add-on you control; if you do, deal 1 extra damage.



### Decoder Spike

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

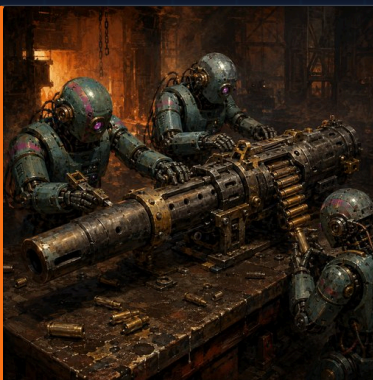
When you play your first Transient each turn, draw a card.



### Forge-Cannon

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

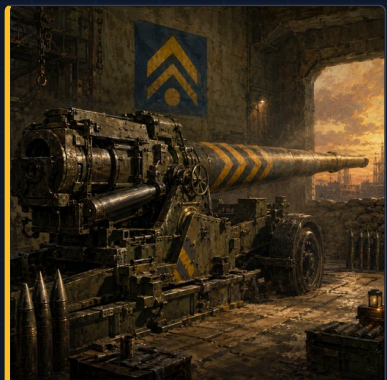
Slot cost: 2. When attached, host has +1 integrity.



### Heavy Spike

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

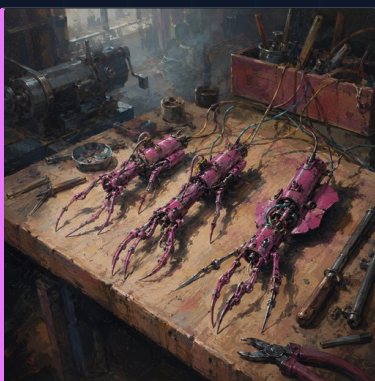
Reclaim 2.



### Heavy Watchpost

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

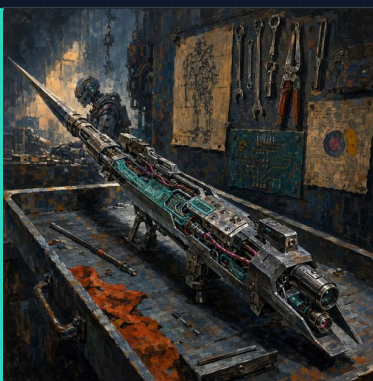
Host cannot attack. When host blocks, host has armor 2 for that combat.



### Helping Claw

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

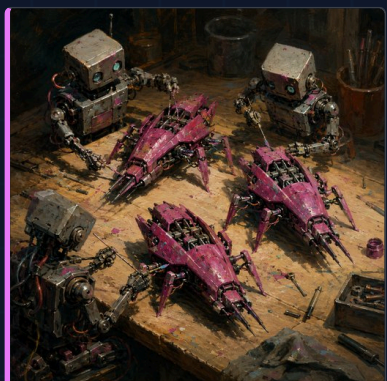
When you play another chassis, this gets +1 power until end of turn (anywhere).



### Heuristic Lance

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

When you play a Transient, this gets +1 power until end of turn.



### Hum-Lance

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

If host has Synchronize, this is +3 / +0 instead.



### Joybuzzer

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

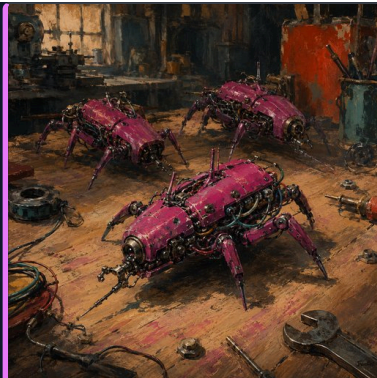
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Joybuzzer is a 2/1.



### Logic Lance

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

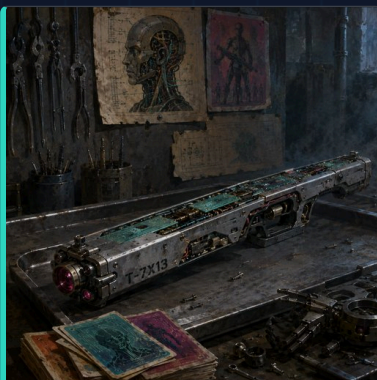
When this attaches, scry 1.



### Magenta Coil

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

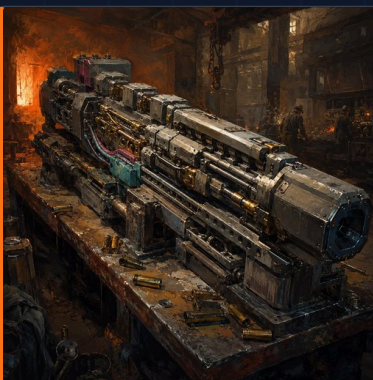
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Magenta Coil is a 4/2.



### Memory Blade

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

When host attacks, you may scrap the top card of your library; if it was a Transient, draw a card.



### Modular Railgun

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

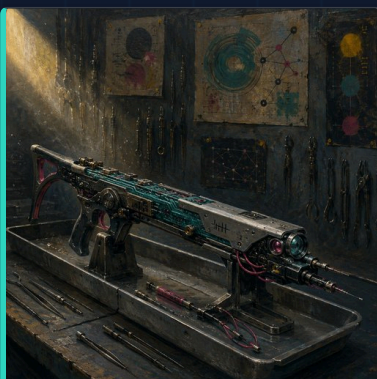
Modular (1 Compute, Reassemble phase: move this to another chassis you control with an open weapon slot). Slot cost: 2.



### Recoil Mount

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

Pay 1 Compute, exhaust: deal 1 damage to a chassis.



### Recursion Hook

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

When this is destroyed, return a Transient from your scrap heap to your hand.



### Riot Baton

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

When host blocks, this gets +1 power until end of turn.



### Riot Mortar

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

When host attacks unblocked, deal 2 workshop damage instead of host's effective power.



### Riveter Mk-I

— • +1 POWER • NEUTRAL

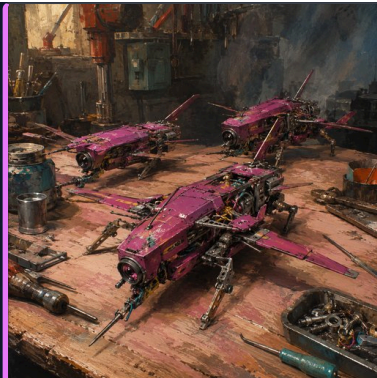
Vanilla.



### Salvage Cleaver

— • +1 POWER • BRICK

When the host destroys a chassis, gain 2 scrap.



### Scout Drone

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

Self-Mobile. While unattached, Scout Drone is a 3/2 instead of a 1/1.



### Sentinel Cannon

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

When host destroys a chassis, gain 1 workshop integrity (max 27).



### Spare Coilgun

— • +1 POWER • NEUTRAL

Vanilla.



### Spark Whip

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

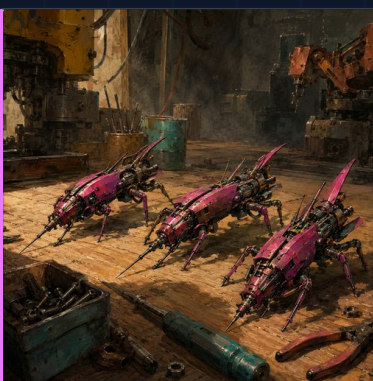
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Spark Whip is a 3/1.



### Standard Issue Blaster

— • +1 POWER • NEUTRAL

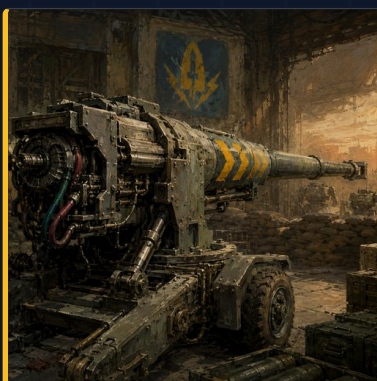
Vanilla.



### Stinger Pack

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

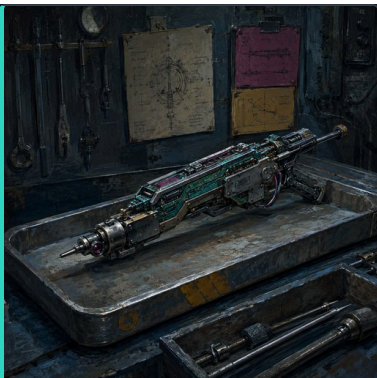
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Stinger Pack is a 2/1.



### Stunner Arm

— • +1 POWER • ARTILLERY

Pay 1 Compute, exhaust host: target opponent's chassis cannot attack next turn.



### Subroutine Driver

— • +1 POWER • CONTROL

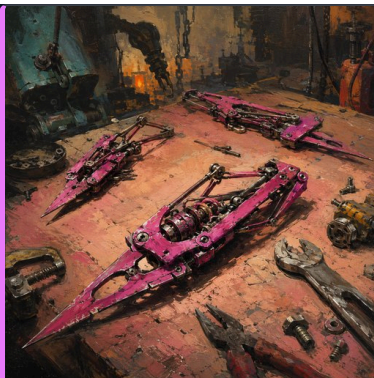
Reclaim 1 (when this is destroyed, gain 1 scrap).



### Tickle-Saw

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

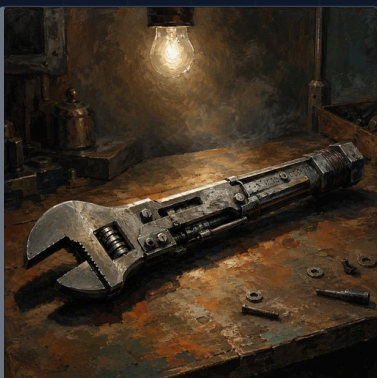
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Tickle-Saw is a 4/1. Slot cost: 1.



### Tinkerblade

— • +1 POWER • SWARM

When this attaches, gain 1 scrap.

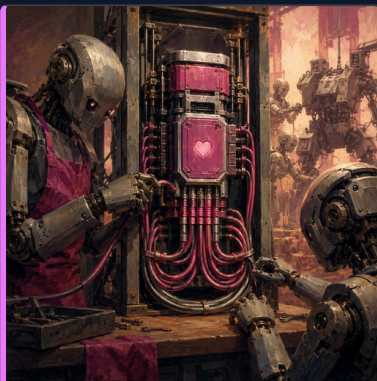


### Workshop Wrench

— • +1 POWER • NEUTRAL

Pay 1 Compute, exhaust host: ready one exhausted add-on you control.

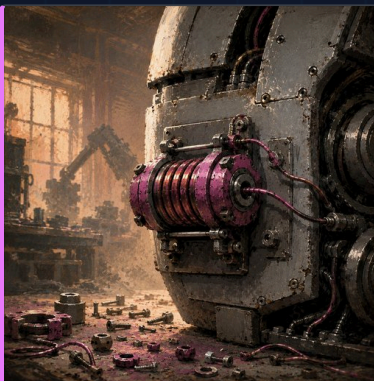
## Add-Ons (35)



### Affection.exe

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

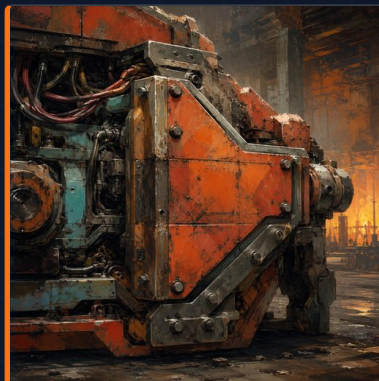
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Affection.exe is a 2/2.



### Affinity Coil

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

Synchronize chassis you control have +1 power.



### Brace Plate

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

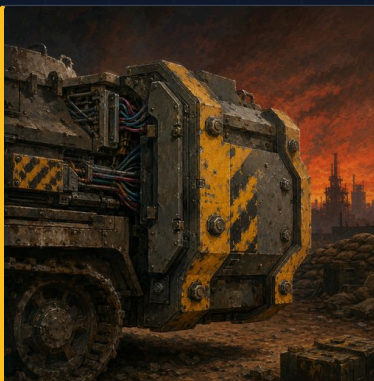
Reclaim 2.



### Bulwark Brace

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

Vanilla.



### Bunker Cradle

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

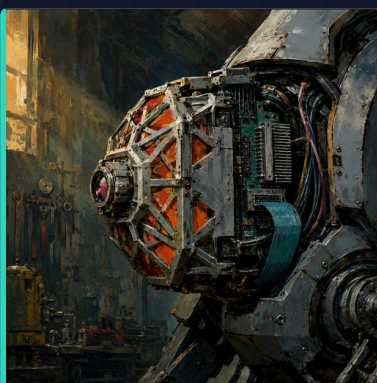
Armor 4 (exhaust to absorb up to 4 damage to host).



### Charm Module

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

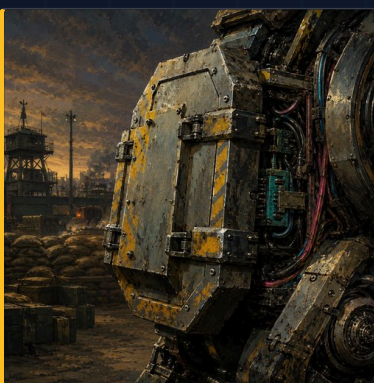
When host attacks unblocked, gain 1 scrap.



### Containment Lattice

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

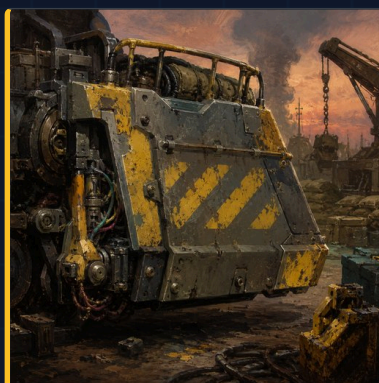
Armor 2 (exhaust to absorb up to 2 damage to host).



### Containment Lining

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

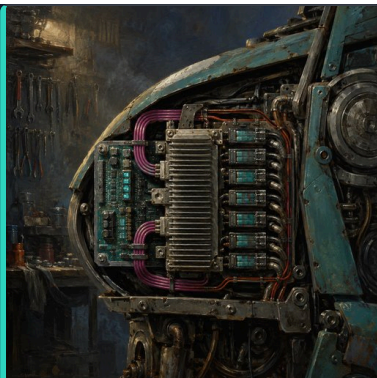
Armor 2. While 3+ add-ons attached to host are exhausted, host has +1 power.



### Coolant Cradle

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

Pay 1 scrap, Reassemble: ready this add-on.



### Cooldown Harness

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

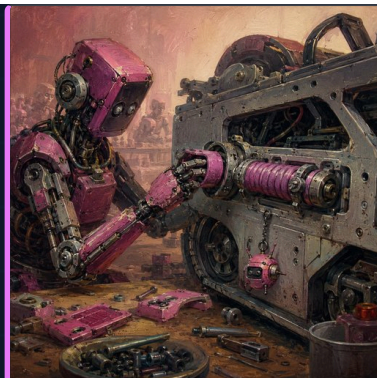
At the start of your Boot phase, ready an additional exhausted add-on you control.



### Counterweight Sleeve

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

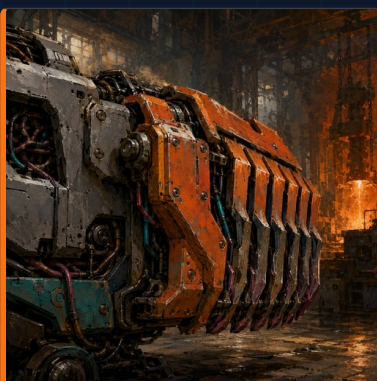
When host blocks, this gets +1 integrity until end of combat.



### Curiosity Routine

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

Self-Mobile. When this attaches, you may attach another part you control to a chassis.



### Foundry Bracer

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

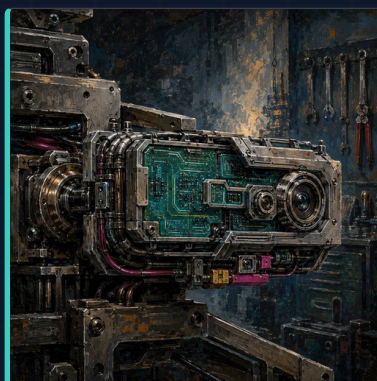
When host attacks, this gets +1 power until end of combat.



### Glee Plating

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

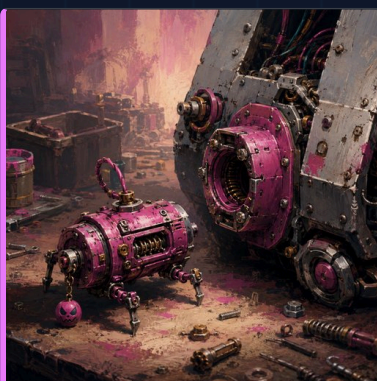
Reclaim 1 (when this is destroyed, gain 1 scrap).



### Heuristic Layer

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

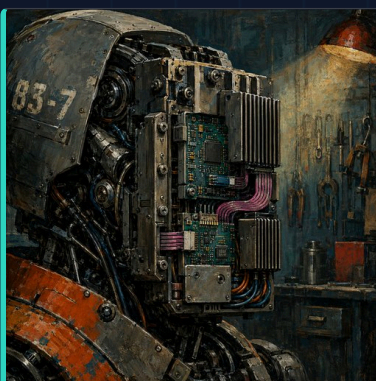
When you play a Transient, draw a card. (Once per turn.)



### Joybuzzer Sleeve

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

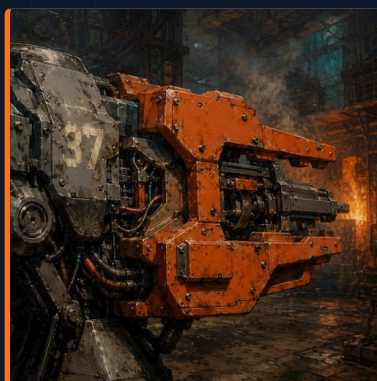
Self-Mobile. While unattached, Joybuzzer Sleeve is a 2/1.



### Logic Buffer

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

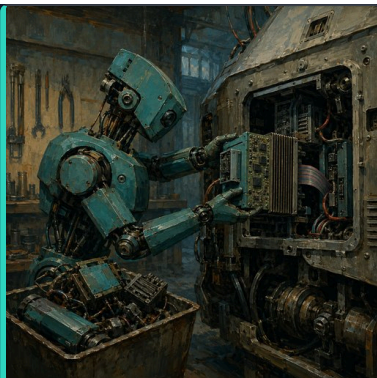
Armor 3.



### Lugnut Cradle

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

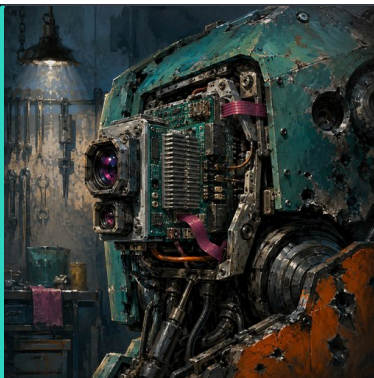
Host has +1 integrity for each weapon attached.



### Memory Buffer

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

Pay 2 Compute, exhaust this: return a Transient from your scrap heap to your hand.



### Patient Frame

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

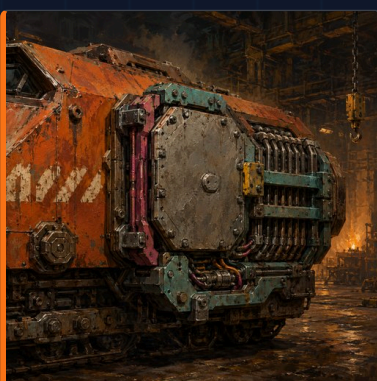
While host has 4+ damage marked, it has +2 power.



### Reactive Shielding

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

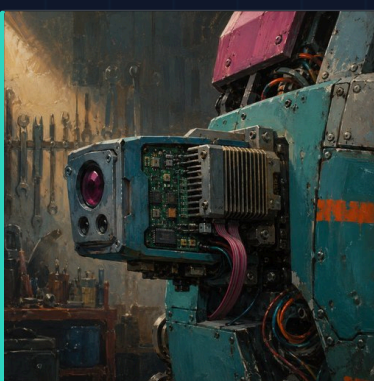
Armor 3 (exhaust to absorb up to 3 damage to host).



### Reactor Shell

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

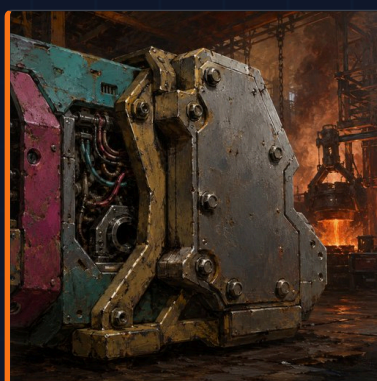
Pay 2 scrap, Reassemble: ready this add-on.



### Recursive Tape

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

When this is destroyed, draw 2 cards.



### Reinforced Plating

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

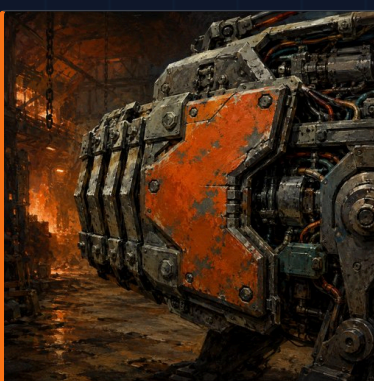
Vanilla.



### Riot Plating

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

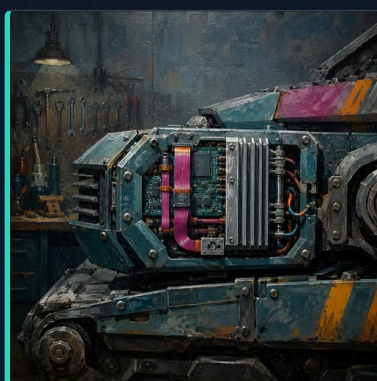
Armor 2. When this absorbs damage, deal 1 damage to the attacker.



### Sacrificial Plating

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

Reclaim 3 (when this is destroyed, gain 3 scrap).



### Soft-Cycle Ridge

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

Armor 2. When this absorbs damage, draw a card.



### Speedlink

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

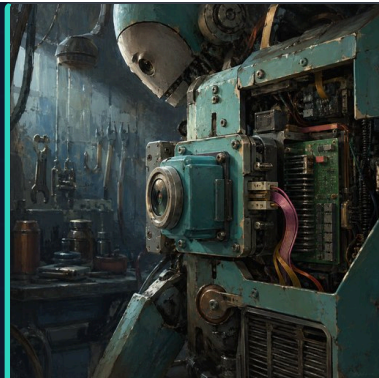
When this attaches, draw a card if you control 3+ chassis.



### Spotter Rig

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

When host blocks, draw a card.



### Subroutine Dampener

— • +1/+1 • CONTROL

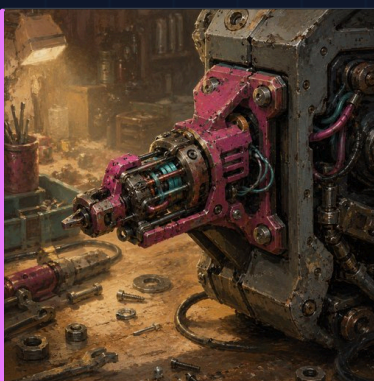
When a Transient you control resolves, host gets +1 integrity until end of turn.



### Thick Hide

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

Armor 2 (exhaust to absorb up to 2 damage to host).



### Tinker's Frame

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

If host has Synchronize, this is +1 / +2 instead.



### Tungsten Carapace

— • +1/+1 • BRICK

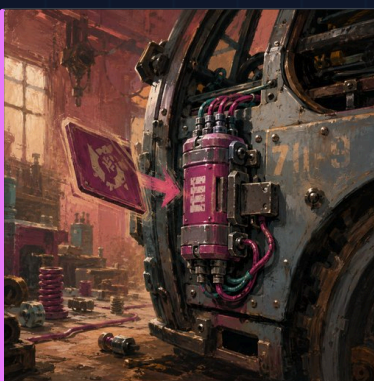
Armor 3.



### Vault Bracer

— • +1/+1 • ARTILLERY

Vanilla.



### Wired Toolkit

— • +1/+1 • SWARM

When this attaches, draw a card.

## Transients (17)



### Big Swing

— • BRICK

Target chassis you control deals damage equal to its effective power to a chassis or Core (does not use combat).



### Burnout Protocol

— • ARTILLERY

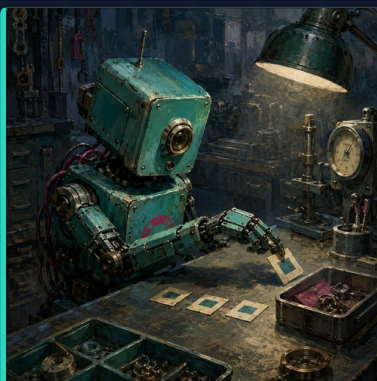
If the deathclock is active, the opponent takes double containment-failure damage at end of turn.



### Containment Recall

— • ARTILLERY

Return a destroyed add-on from your scrap heap to the Assembly Floor exhausted and unattached.



### Diagnostic Sweep

— • CONTROL

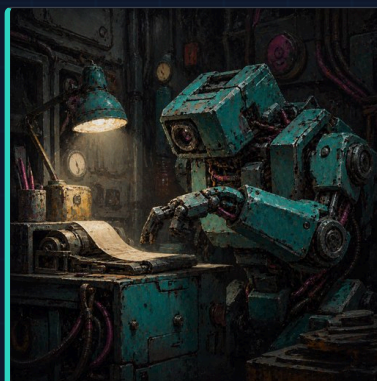
Scry 3 (look at top 3, scrap any, rest on top in any order).



### Forge Stoke

— • BRICK

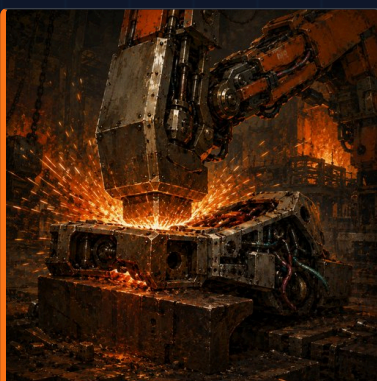
Gain 2 scrap.



### Garbage Collector

— • CONTROL

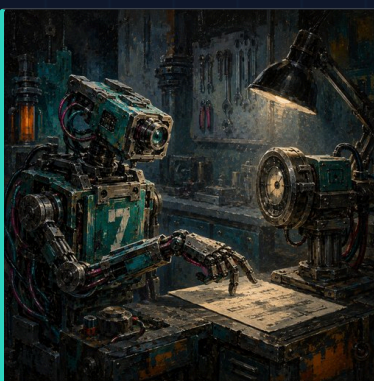
Return a Transient from your scrap heap to your hand.



### Hammer-On

— • BRICK

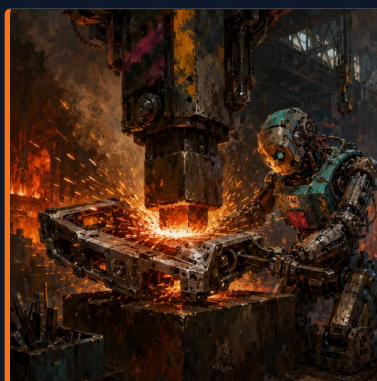
Target chassis you control gets +3 power until end of turn.



### Heuristic Loop

— • CONTROL

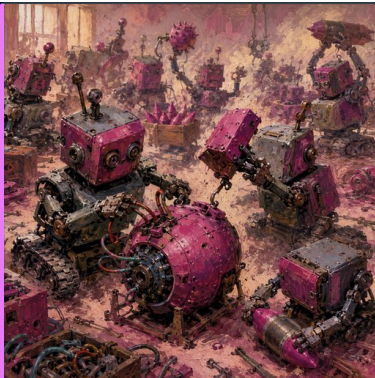
Draw 2 cards. If 3+ Transients are in your scrap heap, draw 1 more.



### Iron Audit

— • BRICK

Scrap a chassis from your hand; put it onto the Assembly Floor exhausted.



### Joybomb

— • SWARM

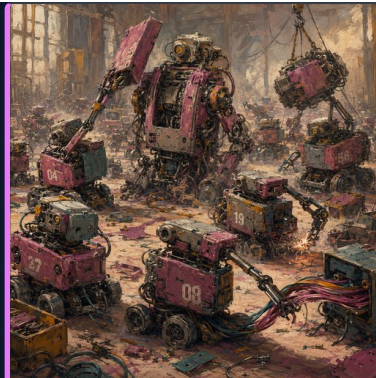
Each chassis you control gets +1 power until end of turn.



### Patch

— • CONTROL

Target chassis you control regains all damage marked (heal full).



### Recall to Workshop

— • SWARM

Return a chassis you control to your hand. (Useful with on-attach triggers.)



### Repair Subroutine

— • ARTILLERY

Ready up to 2 exhausted add-ons you control.



### Reroute Power

— • CONTROL

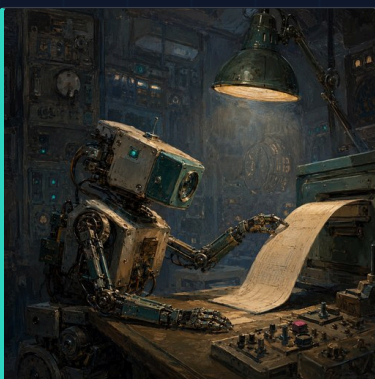
Target chassis deals damage equal to its attached-weapon-count to a chassis or Core.



### Scrap Salvo

— • NEUTRAL

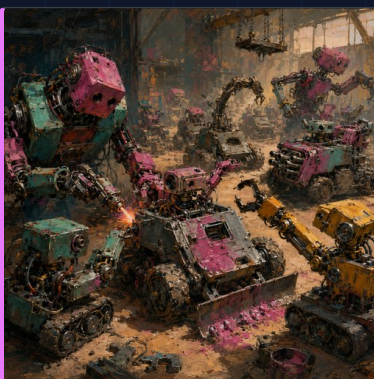
Pay 3 scrap: deal 3 damage to a chassis or Core.



### Subroutine Cascade

— • CONTROL

Draw 3 cards; the next Transient you play this turn costs 2 less Compute (min 0).



### Swarm Surge

— • SWARM

Each chassis you control with Synchronize gets +1/+1 until end of turn.

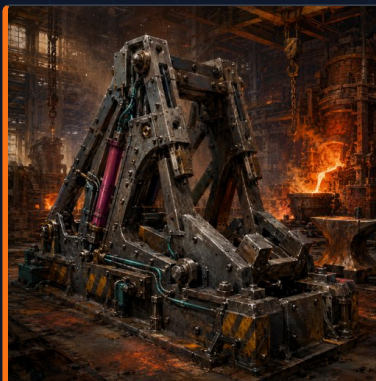
## Structures (13)



### Auxiliary Bench

— • NEUTRAL

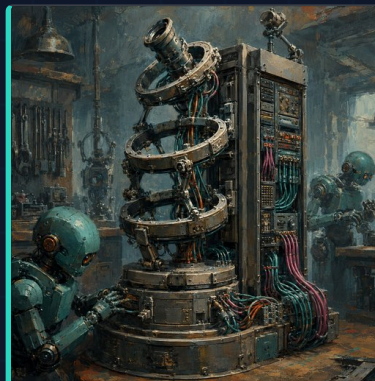
Pay 1 scrap, Reassemble: put a solo Weapon or Add-On you control onto a chassis you control with an open slot. (Free Modular for one part.)



### Compounding Buttreass

— • BRICK

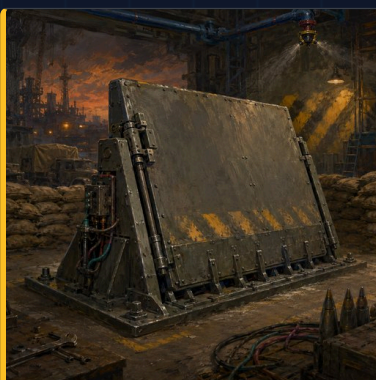
Your chassis with integrity  $\geq 5$  have +1 power.



### Compute Trickle

— • CONTROL

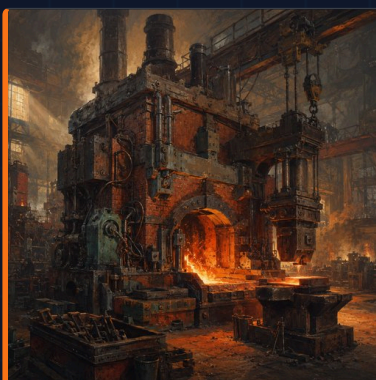
At the start of your Boot phase, gain 1 Compute (above your cap, this turn only).



### Containment Baffle

— • ARTILLERY

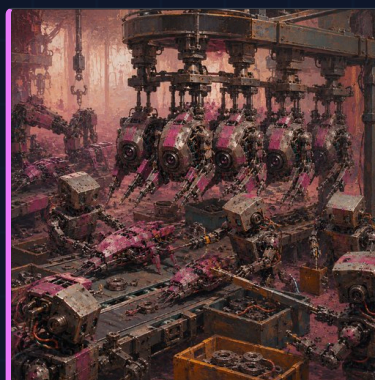
Opposing chassis with effective power  $\geq 4$  must pay 1 extra Compute to attack from the Assembly Floor.



### Heavy Forge

— • BRICK

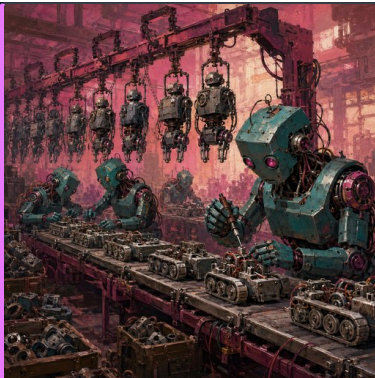
Your Weapons cost 1 less Compute (min 1).



### Iron Cluster

— • SWARM

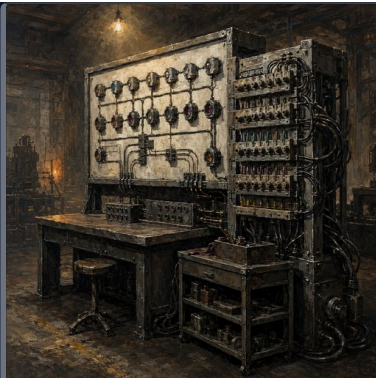
Each Synchronize chassis you control has +1 integrity.



### Mass-Production Line

— • SWARM

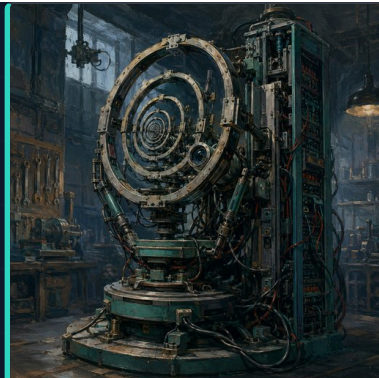
Your chassis with Compute cost  $\leq 2$  enter the floor with +1/+0 (this turn).



### Public Telemetry

— • NEUTRAL

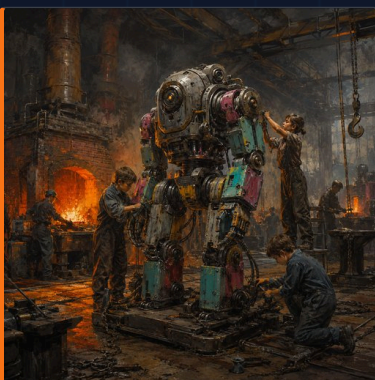
At end of your turn, if you played 0 Transients this turn, gain 1 Compute next turn (above your cap, that turn only).



### Recursive Observatory

— • CONTROL

Reticulate (at end of turn, if you played no Transients this turn, draw a card).



### Reinforced Bay

— • BRICK

Your chassis enter the floor with 1 damage marked prevented.



### Shared Bus

— • NEUTRAL

The first part you play each turn costs 1 less Compute (min 0).



### Swarm Beacon

— • SWARM

Your chassis have +1 power if you control 3 or more chassis.



### Workshop Sprinkler

— • ARTILLERY

At end of your turn, ready an additional exhausted add-on you control.

## SECTION 10

## Quick Reference

### Turn order cheat sheet

- |   |            |                                                                         |
|---|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | BOOT       | Untap. Compute = $\min(10, 3 + \text{turn})$ .<br>Structure upkeep.     |
| 2 | ALLOCATE   | MAY draw to 7. (Decline to slow your deathclock.)                       |
| 3 | ASSEMBLE   | Play / attach / activate. Pay Compute.<br>Hearthstone-style resolution. |
| 4 | COMBAT     | You declare attackers; opp blocks 1-for-1.<br>Damage simultaneous.      |
| 5 | REASSEMBLE | Second Assemble window. Modular weapons<br>relocate. Patch heals.       |
| 6 | CLEANUP    | EOT triggers. Damage persists. Pass<br>priority.                        |

### Resource reference

| RESOURCE           | START | PER TURN                 | CAP  | CARRYOVER |
|--------------------|-------|--------------------------|------|-----------|
| Compute            | 0     | $+\min(\text{cap}, 3+T)$ | 10   | No        |
| Scrap              | 0     | from kills/cards         | 10   | Yes       |
| Workshop Integrity | 30*   | — (combat-driven)        | 30*  | Yes       |
| Hand               | 7     | refill to 7 once/turn    | soft | Yes       |

\* Some Cores ship with different starting Workshop Integrity. BULWARK-9 starts at 27; ETHOS-7 starts at 22.

### Common timing Q&A

### Q: WHEN DOES SYNCHRONIZE ACTIVATE?

The lord chain checks at action time: if you control exactly 2 or 3 Synchronize chassis, all of them get +1 power. With 4+, the bonus is 0 (over-couples). With 1, just the printed stats — no bonus.

### Q: CAN I ATTACH A PART TO AN OPPOSING CHASSIS?

No. The same-controller restriction is enforced at attach time. Sabotage-style cross-controller attachment is a future-set hook.

### Q: WHEN DOES ARMOR GET SPENT?

Armor N is a **replacement** effect on a DAMAGE event. You declare you're spending Armor before the damage applies, exhaust the add-on, and the damage payload reduces by N. Once damage applies, you can't retroactively spend armor.

### Q: DOES DAMAGE ON A CHASSIS HEAL BETWEEN TURNS?

**No.** Damage marked on a chassis persists indefinitely. To clear it, play the Patch Transient (full heal of one chassis), or let the chassis die and rebuild.

### Q: SOLO PARTS CAN BLOCK, RIGHT?

Yes. Unattached weapons and add-ons on the Assembly Floor are baseline 1/1 (or higher with Self-Mobile) and validate as legal blockers. They'll die to most attacks but they absorb the damage.

### Q: WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PATCH AND REPAIR SUBROUTINE?

**Patch** (ETHOS, 1 Compute) full-heals a chassis's damage\_marked.

**Repair Subroutine** (BULWARK, 2 Compute) **readies** up to 2 exhausted add-ons — it does NOT heal damage. They look similar in the rulebook; they do completely different things.

### Q: WHEN DOES THE DEATHCLOCK START?

The moment **either** library reaches 5 cards. Not when both empty (that was the original rule, changed in Wave 4C). Whichever library hits 5 first triggers Containment Failure. From then on every End-of-Turn does escalating damage (2, 4, 8, 16, ...) to both Cores.

---

CLAN — Workshop Genesis · Operator's Manual v1 · Generated 2026-05-24  
Engine: `src/engine/clankers*.py` · Cards: `src/cards/clankers/CLAN/`